ONE LAST PLATE

THE TABLE WE SET TOGETHER

We began by asking you to pull up a chair. Now, fifty states later, the plates are nearly cleared—and this is the part of the meal that has always mattered most.

Somewhere back at the start of this book, we said that food is how we remember where we've been. We hope, by now, that the idea has cooked all the way through. Because if you made even a handful of these dishes, you didn't just cross the country—you tasted it. You stood, for an evening, in a New Haven pizzeria and an Alabama backyard and a Lowcountry rice kitchen, and you carried a little of each of them home.

That was always the point. These recipes were never really about the food alone. They were about the hands that first made them, and the reasons those hands reached for what was near: the catfish in the river, the huckleberries on the mountainside, the hog that could not be wasted, the wheat that came across an ocean in someone's pocket. Every dish in this book is a small act of ingenuity and love, passed down until it landed, somehow, on your stove. You are the newest cook in a very long line.

And you've added something of your own now, too. A little too much pepper, maybe, or a substitution born of an empty cupboard, or the particular way your kitchen smells when the oven has been on all afternoon. That is how these dishes have always survived—not by staying the same, but by being made again, by someone new, in a place the last cook never imagined. The recipe on the page is only the beginning of the sentence. You finish it.

So keep this book somewhere it can get a little splattered. Lend it out. Argue with it. Make the cobbler for a birthday and the chowder for a cold night and the hot chicken for someone you're trying to impress. A country, in the end, is just a great many tables—and every time you set one, you make a little more room at it.

★

Thank you for pulling up a chair.
The plate is always yours to pass.

FROM OUR TABLE TO YOURS

MENUS FOR THE OCCASION

Fifty states make a long and happy table, but a good meal is rarely eaten one dish at a time. What follows are a few gatherings drawn from across the country—plates that were never neighbors by geography, but that sit down together beautifully all the same. Cook a whole menu, or borrow a single dish and build your own. There is no wrong way to set this table.

The Fourth of July

Smoke, char, and something cold and sweet to finish—the country's birthday, coast to coast.

Grilled Chicken Sliders with Alabama White Sauce · *Alabama* 15
Elk Burgers with Spicy Huckleberry BBQ Sauce · *Montana* 127
Fried Green Tomatoes · *North Carolina* 155
Cast-Iron Skillet Cornbread · *Oklahoma* 167
Georgia Peach Cobbler · *Georgia* 53

A Sunday Supper

The slow, unhurried meal that anchors a week—a roast at the center and a pie to linger over.

Wild Rice Soup · *Minnesota* 113
Buffet-Style Prime Rib Roast with Pan Jus · *Nevada* 135
Funeral Potatoes · *Utah* 203
Apple Pie with Cheddar Cheese · *Vermont* 207

An East Coast Seaside Table

Everything the eastern U.S. coast gives up—briny, buttery, and best eaten with your sleeves pushed up. Choose one or two for a small meal, or serve all four when family and friends are joining.

New England Clam Chowder · *Massachusetts* 105
Steamed Crabs · *Maryland* 101
Lobster Roll · *Maine* 97
Key Lime Grilled Grouper and Coconut Rice · *Florida* 49

A Cozy Winter Table

For the short, cold days—deep pots, long simmers, and warmth that fills the whole kitchen. Only one of these will do.

Burgoo · *Kentucky* 85
Gumbo · *Louisiana* 92
Knoephla Soup · *North Dakota* 159

A Weekend Breakfast

The meal worth waking up for, made slow—a griddle going and no one watching the clock.

Denver Omelet · *Colorado* 37
Scrapple Breakfast Sandwich · *Delaware* 45
Buckwheat Pancakes · *West Virginia* 220
Biscochitos · *New Mexico* 147

Game Day

Food built for a crowd and a couch—handheld, hearty, and happy to be shared.

Philly Cheesesteak · *Pennsylvania* 176
Chicago Dog · *Illinois* 67
Cincinnati Chili · *Ohio* 163
Chislic · *South Dakota* 191
Kringle · *Wisconsin* 224

A Road-Trip Picnic

Wrapped, packed, and carried—the flavors of the open road, meant to be eaten somewhere with a view.

Michigan-Style Cornish Pasty · *Michigan* 108
Bierock · *Kansas* 81
Fish Tacos · *California* 31
Gooey Butter Cake · *Missouri* 121

COOK WITH CONFIDENCE

A GUIDE TO ALLERGENS

Every kitchen has someone to cook around—gluten to avoid, shellfish to steer clear of, a nut that can't come near the table. This guide sorts every dish in the book (sauces and sides are listed with the dish they serve) so you can find what fits, or see at a glance what to adjust. Where an allergen hides in a single, swappable ingredient, we've said so—because a good recipe should bend to the cook, not the other way around.

Free of All Major Allergens

No wheat, dairy, egg, shellfish, fish, peanut, tree nut, soy, or sesame in the recipe as written.

Kalua Pork · *Hawaii* 57
Corned Beef Boiled Dinner · *New Hampshire* 139
Chislic* · *South Dakota* 191

**Fried in vegetable oil, not peanut oil.*

Gluten-Free

Naturally, as written—always confirm broths, sauces, and seasoning blends carry no hidden wheat.

Fried Catfish with Arkansas-Style Tartar Sauce · *Arkansas* 27
Akutaq · *Alaska* 19
Denver Omelet · *Colorado* 37
Key Lime Grilled Grouper and Coconut Rice · *Florida* 49
Burgoo · *Kentucky* 85
Buffet-Style Prime Rib Roast with Pan Jus · *Nevada* 135
Corned Beef Boiled Dinner · *New Hampshire* 139
Johnnycakes · *Rhode Island* 181
Gullah Shrimp and Sausage Perloo · *South Carolina* 186
Chislic · *South Dakota* 191
Cedar-Planked Salmon with Honey-Balsamic Glaze · *Washington* 215
Cowboy Cutthroat Trout · *Wyoming* 229

Dairy-Free

Naturally, as written—some offer butter or cheese only as an optional finish, easily left out.

Grilled Chicken Sliders with Alabama White Sauce · *Alabama* 15
Akutaq · *Alaska* 19
Kalua Pork · *Hawaii* 57
Chicago Dog · *Illinois* 67
Burgoo · *Kentucky* 85
Gumbo · *Louisiana* 92
Corned Beef Boiled Dinner · *New Hampshire* 139
Chislic · *South Dakota* 191
Chili con Carne · *Texas* 199
Cedar-Planked Salmon with Honey-Balsamic Glaze · *Washington* 215

RECIPES THAT CONTAIN

Contains Shellfish

Crab, clam, lobster, or shrimp—central to the dish and not removable.

White Clam Apizza · *Connecticut* 41
Gumbo · *Louisiana* 92
Lobster Roll · *Maine* 97
Steamed Crabs · *Maryland* 101
New England Clam Chowder · *Massachusetts* 105
Gullah Shrimp and Sausage Perloo · *South Carolina* 186

Contains Fish

The fish is the dish and cannot be removed.

Akutaq · *Alaska* 19
Fried Catfish with Arkansas-Style Tartar Sauce · *Arkansas* 27
Fish Tacos · *California* 31
Key Lime Grilled Grouper and Coconut Rice · *Florida* 49
Cedar-Planked Salmon with Honey-Balsamic Glaze · *Washington* 215
Cowboy Cutthroat Trout · *Wyoming* 229

Contains Fish—Hidden Source

Fish is present only through Worcestershire sauce, which contains anchovy. A fish-free Worcestershire (or a splash of soy or coconut aminos) removes it.

Fry Sauce · *Idaho* 62
Burgoo · *Kentucky* 85
Gumbo · *Louisiana* 92
Elk Burgers with Spicy Huckleberry BBQ Sauce · *Montana* 127
Cincinnati Chili · *Ohio* 163
Philly Cheesesteak · *Pennsylvania* 176
Peanut Soup · *Virginia* 211

Contains Eggs

Whole eggs, yolks, or egg-based mayonnaise. Some appear only as an egg wash or optional binder.

Grilled Chicken Sliders with Alabama White Sauce · *Alabama* 15
Fried Catfish with Arkansas-Style Tartar Sauce · *Arkansas* 27
Fish Tacos · *California* 31
Denver Omelet · *Colorado* 37
Scrapple Breakfast Sandwich · *Delaware* 45
Fry Sauce · *Idaho* 62
Hoosier Pie · *Indiana* 71
Ham Balls with Sweet Sauce · *Iowa* 77
Bierock · *Kansas* 81
Lobster Roll · *Maine* 97
Michigan-Style Cornish Pasty · *Michigan* 108
Mississippi Mud Pie · *Mississippi* 117
Gooey Butter Cake · *Missouri* 121
Elk Burgers with Spicy Huckleberry BBQ Sauce · *Montana* 127
Cheese Frenchee · *Nebraska* 131
Pork Roll · *New Jersey* 143
Biscochitos · *New Mexico* 147
Fried Green Tomatoes · *North Carolina* 155
Knoephla Soup · *North Dakota* 159
Cast-Iron Skillet Cornbread · *Oklahoma* 167
Apple Pie with Cheddar Cheese · *Vermont* 207
Kringle · *Wisconsin* 224

Contains Peanuts

True peanuts—peanut butter and roasted peanuts—essential to the dish.

Peanut Soup · *Virginia* 211

Contains Tree Nuts

Pecans, almonds, or coconut. In Florida coconut is central; in Mississippi and Wisconsin the nuts appear as a topping or flavoring that can often be omitted.

Key Lime Grilled Grouper and Coconut Rice · *Florida* 49
Mississippi Mud Pie · *Mississippi* 117
Kringle · *Wisconsin* 224

Contains Soy

Present through soy sauce, which can be swapped for coconut aminos.

Cedar-Planked Salmon with Honey-Balsamic Glaze · *Washington* 215

A Note on Peanut Oil

These fried recipes list "peanut or vegetable oil." Refined peanut oil is generally considered safe for most peanut allergies, and each offers vegetable oil as an equal substitute. If in any doubt, choose the vegetable oil.

Sonoran-Style Chimichanga · *Arizona* 23
Fried Catfish with Arkansas-Style Tartar Sauce · *Arkansas* 27
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Fry Sauce · *Idaho* 62
Cheese Frenchee · *Nebraska* 131
Jo Jo Potatoes · *Oregon* 173
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Fried Chicken with Spicy Nashville Paste · *Tennessee* 195

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Chicago Dog · *Illinois* 67
Chicken Riggies · *New York* 151
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Chislic · *South Dakota* 191
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Cowboy Cutthroat Trout · *Wyoming* 229
Denver Omelet · *Colorado* 37
Elk Burgers with Spicy Huckleberry BBQ Sauce · *Montana* 127
Finger Steaks with Fry Sauce and French Fries · *Idaho* 61
Fish Tacos · *California* 31
French Fries · *Idaho* 62
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Fried Chicken with Spicy Nashville Paste · *Tennessee* 195
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